

AZ-900 · Core services cheat sheet

Skilltimate Learn · keep beside you during mock review — one line per service, the way the exam phrases them.

Compute

Virtual Machines	IaaS. Full control of OS. Lift-and-shift migrations.
App Service	PaaS web hosting. Deploy code, platform handles the rest.
Azure Functions	Serverless. Event-driven code, billed per execution.
AKS	Managed Kubernetes for container orchestration.
Azure Virtual Desktop	Windows desktops streamed from the cloud.

Networking

Virtual Network (VNet)	Private network in Azure; subnets, private IPs.
VPN Gateway	Encrypted tunnel between on-premises and Azure over the internet.
ExpressRoute	Private dedicated circuit to Azure — never touches the public internet.
Azure DNS	Host DNS domains alongside your Azure services.

Storage

Blob Storage	Unstructured objects: images, video, backups, logs.
Azure Files	Managed SMB/NFS file shares, mountable like a normal drive.
Disk Storage	Block storage attached to VMs.
Storage tiers	Hot (frequent), Cool (30+ days), Archive (180+ days, hours to rehydrate).

Databases

Azure SQL Database	PaaS relational SQL Server engine.
Cosmos DB	Globally distributed NoSQL, millisecond latency, multiple APIs.
Azure Database for MySQL/PostgreSQL	Managed open-source relational engines.

Identity, governance & management

Microsoft Entra ID	Cloud identity and access management (formerly Azure AD).
RBAC	Who can do what, on which resource scope.
Azure Policy	Enforce organisational rules across resources (e.g. allowed regions).
Resource locks	Prevent accidental delete/change; CanNotDelete and ReadOnly.
Microsoft Cost Management	Analyse, budget and alert on spend.
Azure Monitor	Metrics and logs platform; Application Insights for APM.
Azure Advisor	Personalised recommendations: cost, security, reliability, performance.
Service Health	Azure-side incidents and planned maintenance affecting you.